



University of
St Andrews

Participant Information Sheet – Parents/Guardians (0-12y)

2025v1.2]

USER-CENTRED DESIGN OF GAMES FOR GAELIC DIGITAL NORMALISATION

Student: Luke Macleod, Final Year Computer Science Student

Supervisor: Dr Abd Alsattar Ardati, School of Computer Science, University of St Andrews

What is the study about?

We invite you to permit your child/ward's participation in a research project examining how digital games can be developed and used to support Gaelic language learning and active Gaelic usage within Gaelic Medium Education (GME) contexts. This research explores the development and evaluation of digital games designed to promote Gaelic language use through interactive activities. The study seeks to understand how game-based interaction can contribute to Gaelic digital normalisation, making Gaelic a more natural part of learners' everyday digital experiences.

Why have they been invited to take part?

Your child/ward has been invited to participate because they are enrolled in a Gaelic Medium Education programme. We are specifically seeking children who meet the following criteria:

- Aged 8–12 years and enrolled in GME
- Have upper primary GME levels of Gaelic proficiency
- Familiar with technology-based activities
- Have been identified by their teacher as suitable for research participation
- Your consent as a parent/guardian is required before your child/ward can participate

Do they have to take part?

This information sheet has been written to help you and your child/ward decide whether they should take part. It is up to you and your child/ward alone whether they wish to take part. If you and your child/ward decide to take part, they will be free to withdraw at any time without providing a reason, and with no negative consequences.

What would they be required to do?

If you consent, your child/ward will engage in one research session lasting approximately 45–60 minutes during regular school hours. The session will include:

- Game-Playing Activities (30–40 minutes)
- Your child/ward will interact with a game prototype designed for Gaelic language engagement
- All activities are designed to be engaging and age-appropriate
- Technical difficulties will be minimised through pre-testing
- Filling out a short post-game evaluation questionnaire
- Discussion Group (10–15 minutes)
- Your child/ward will discuss their gaming experience using child-friendly language
- Questions will focus on enjoyment, comprehension, cultural fit, and suggestions for improvement
- No formal assessment or testing of Gaelic language ability will occur
- There are no repeat activities or additional visits required.

Are there any risks associated with taking part?

Risks have been assessed as minimal. Potential risks include:

- Minor inconvenience (time commitment during school hours)
- Potential mild fatigue or discomfort from extended screen time
- Possible discomfort if a child finds the technology or game challenging

Steps to minimise or mitigate risks:

- The classroom teacher will be present throughout all activities, providing familiar support
- Research is conducted during regular school hours in a familiar school environment
- All interactions follow child protection guidelines and safeguarding protocols
- Technical support will be provided by the researcher if necessary
- Immediate cessation of activities will occur if your child/ward shows any signs of distress or discomfort
- The research focuses solely on game interaction and does not involve psychological assessment
- Games have been developed with consideration of Gaelic cultural context to ensure cultural sensitivity
- If your child/ward experiences any concerns, the teacher will be available to provide support immediately.

Informed Consent

It is important that you and your child/ward can give your informed consent before taking part in this study, and they will have the opportunity to ask any questions in relation to the research before they provide consent. In addition to your consent as a parent/guardian, at the beginning of the session, the researcher will explain the study to your child/ward in age-appropriate language and confirm their willingness to participate. Your child/ward can stop at any time, and we will monitor their comfort throughout.

Are there any benefits associated with taking part?

Your child/ward's participation will contribute to important work supporting Gaelic digital resource development. Potential benefits include:

- Early access to newly developed technology
- Opportunity for your child/ward's voice to directly influence resources designed for their community
- Contribution to supporting the development of Gaelic digital resources for current and future GME learners
- Research findings that may improve Gaelic digital resource development and inform policy recommendations

Reward/compensation

Your child/ward will receive a small stationery item and a printed certificate of participation as a token of appreciation.

What information about my child or recordings of them ('their data') will you be collecting?

Data will be collected through the following methods:

- Direct observation: Researcher field notes on your child/ward's gameplay interactions and engagement
- Screen recording: Screen recordings of gameplay sessions for usability analysis (no personal identifiers will be captured in recordings)

- Brief questionnaire: Age-appropriate questions about your child/ward's experience (multiple choice and open-ended formats about the game's usability, cultural fit, and their enjoyment)
- Group discussion: Researcher notes on your child/ward's responses during group discussions

Terms used to describe your child/ward's data:

- **Pseudonymised:** Your child/ward's data will be assigned a participant code (e.g., "P01") instead of your child/ward's name, with a secure key linking the code to their identity (retained only by the research team). Once this key is deleted your child/ward's data becomes anonymised.
- **Anonymised:** Data edited or deleted such that no one, including researchers, can identify your child/ward.

How will our data be stored and who will have access to it?

Data will be initially stored in **pseudonymised** form on secure University cloud servers. Only the researcher and supervisor will have access to the data.

The key linking your child/ward's code to their identity will be stored in a separate secure location, accessible only to the researcher. 48 hours after data collection is complete, this key will be deleted, meaning you and your child/ward's data will be fully **anonymised**.

How will my child's data be used and in what form will it be shared further?

- Your child/ward's data will be analysed for this research study, and only anonymised data may be included in the researcher's dissertation, academic publications, or presentations.
- Your child/ward's data may be made publicly available in an anonymised form by placing it in a data repository for the purpose of further research. All users, including the public, will have access.
- It is expected that the project to which this research relates will be finalised by April 2026

When will our data be destroyed?

All pseudonymised data will be destroyed safely 48 hours after data collection; thereafter, anonymised data will be retained for the duration of the project.

Will our participation be confidential?

Your child/ward's participation in the research activity will be kept confidential by the research team. However, because this is a group classroom-based session, other children, parents, teachers, and school staff in your school may be aware that your child/ward is participating in the research. Additionally, the classroom teacher and school staff will be present during the session. When research findings are published or shared, all data will be anonymised to protect your child/ward's identity. Your child/ward will not be identifiable from any published materials or research reports.

Use of you and your child/ward's personal data for research and your data protection rights

The University of St Andrews (the 'Data Controller') is bound by the UK 2018 Data Protection Act and the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), which require a lawful basis for all processing of personal data (in this case it is the 'performance of a task carried out in the public interest' – namely, for research purposes) and an additional lawful basis for processing personal data containing special characteristics (in this case it is 'public interest research'). You have a range of rights under data protection legislation. For more information on data protection legislation and your rights visit <https://www.st-andrews.ac.uk/terms/data-protection/rights/>. For any queries, email dataprot@st-andrews.ac.uk.

Withdrawing your data

You can withdraw you and your child/ward's data **up to 48 hours after the data is collected**. When you and your child/ward's data is anonymised, we will not be able to withdraw it, because we will not know which data belongs to you or your child/ward. Should you want to have your data removed, please e-mail the researcher or supervisor as soon as possible within this period.

Ethical Approvals

This research proposal has been scrutinised and subsequently granted ethical approval by the University of St Andrews Teaching and Research Ethics Committee. [APPROVAL NUMBER TO BE INSERTED]

What should we do if we have concerns about this study?

In the first instance, you are encouraged to raise your concerns with the researcher. However, if you do not feel comfortable doing so, then you should contact the supervisor or the School Ethics Contact (contact details below). A full outline of the procedures governed by the University Teaching and Research Ethics Committee is available at:

<https://www.st-andrews.ac.uk/research/integrity-ethics/humans/ethical-guidance/complaints/>.

Contact details:

Researcher: Luke Macleod University email address: lcm31@st-andrews.ac.uk	Supervisor: Dr Abd Alsattar Ardati University email address: abd.ardati@st-andrews.ac.uk University telephone number: +44 (0)1334 46 1861	School ethics contact: Dr Olexandr Konovalov University email address: obk1@st-andrews.ac.uk University telephone number: +44 (0)1334 46 1633
--	--	--